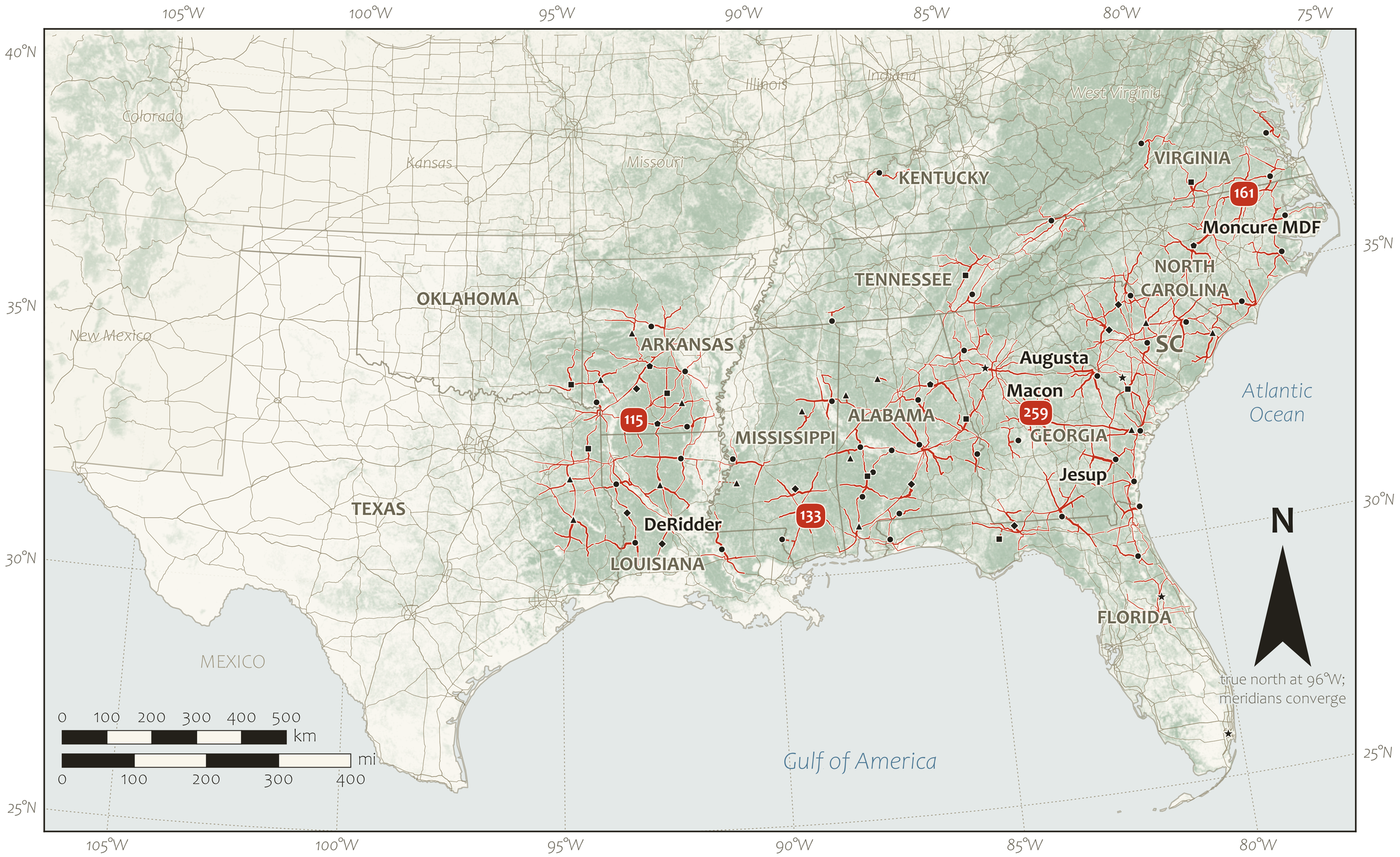
30 DAYS 30 MAPS · DAY 2 · LINES

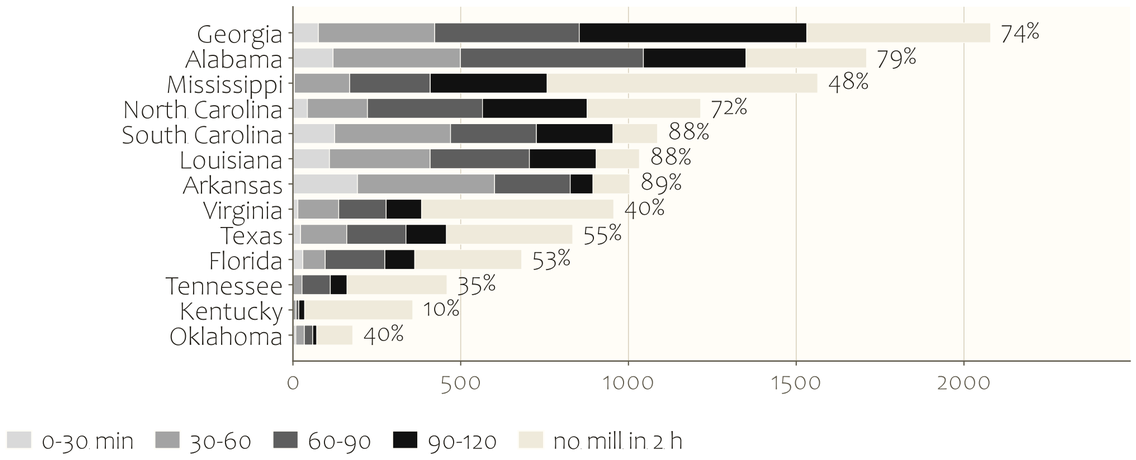
Forest to mill

Half of the modelled wood movement runs on just
10% of the road segments that carry any wood.



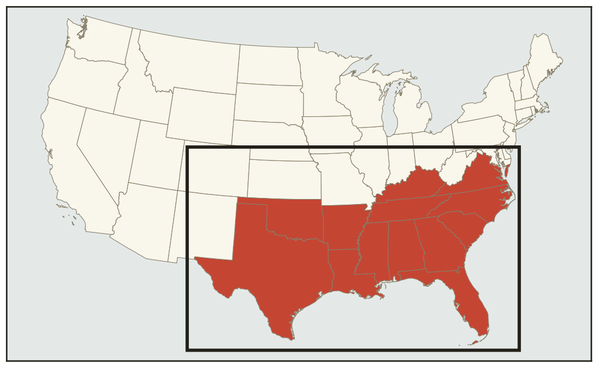
How far is each state's wood from a mill?

FIA removals by minutes to the nearest sample mill, million ft³ a year.
The label is the share of the state's removals within a 2 h haul of any mill.



Study area

Colour = the 13 study states.
Box = the extent of the map above.



13.2 bn
ft³ a year of FIA removals

66%
within 2 h of a mill

87
mills receiving wood

LEGEND

Wood moved, million ft³ a year (modelled)

1 10 50 150 250

- Other roads
- State boundary
- Link between mapped road and mill
- 5° graticule
- 259 Busiest road segment, million ft³/yr

Tree canopy, NLCD 2021

0% 100%

Mill type

- ● Pulp (46)
- ◆ Plywood (8)
- ▲ Sawmill (16)
- ⬟ MDF (4)
- ■ OSB (9)
- ★ Paper (4)

HOW TO READ IT

Each forest hex (842 km²) sends its FIA removals to every mill within a 2 hour road haul, weighted by travel time: a mill 15 minutes farther than the nearest receives about 37% of its share. Road thickness is the wood summed over every route crossing a segment, and each haul is counted once.

WHAT THIS MAP CAN AND CANNOT TELL YOU

This is a model of potential wood movement, not a count of real trucks. It assumes that all forest removals reported by the USDA Forest Service, which include land clearing as well as harvest, go to the mills in my sample by the fastest route on major roads. A dashed link shows where a mill sits off those roads. The mill list is a sample, so an empty area usually means missing mills, not missing demand. Tree canopy is a satellite estimate and is not the FIA definition of forest. Speeds are assumed; mill size, tree species and truck weight limits are not included.

Data: USDA Forest Service FIA county estimates (2016-2025 evaluations); USFS NLCD Tree Canopy Cover v2025-6 (2021); Natural Earth 1:10m roads; US Census state boundaries; mills: author-compiled sample (Forisk / PPRC 2025, company announcements, trade press). Spherical Albers equal-area conic, standard parallels 29.5°N and 45.5°N, origin 37.5°N 96°W.